

friends predicted that even the Bedouins, who "can see a hare behind a tuft of grass a kilometre off," "would pluck the English sentinels like flowers," and that 80,000 men at least would be required to restore the Khedive. But Arabi, the people, the Bedouins and all, have betrayed their friends. Probably the most extraordinary failure of all was that of the Bedouins on the night before the attack, when they let the invading army get within 1,000 yards of Arabi's position in the open desert without giving the alarm. For men who could see a hare a mile off this certainly showed a distressing want of vigilance. But every other incident of the campaign was in keeping with this one, and now the abject submission of the chief gives what ought to be a tragedy the air of a rather broad burlesque.

How this impression of Egyptian desperation got abroad, it is not easy to see if we examine Egyptian history only. Egyptian troops have never made a respectable figure in any war, and those who know the fellah best are most emphatic in denying him all military qualities. He has all sorts of good stuff in him, but he has not the stuff of a good soldier. Nor is there much support for the expectations about him to be found in the history of other Mohammedan peoples. It is more than two centuries since any Mohammedan force was considered formidable on account of its morale. The Persians and the Indian Mussulmans have, during that period, displayed nothing but feebleness and want of enterprise in the field. The Turks have, since the siege of Vienna, shown none of their old martial fire, and have constantly receded before Christian aggression. The defence at Plevna was rather an accident than a revival. Their success during the fourteenth, fifteenth, and sixteenth centuries was due—as any one may see who reads Busbecq's 'Memoirs'—rather to their superiority to Europeans in discipline, in organization, and in armament, than to religious zeal. In other words, the Europe they terrified was a collection of poor barbarous and disorderly states, in which the military art was hardly cultivated at all. The success of the Turks was therefore enormous, and there can hardly be a better illustration of the terror they inspired in Christendom than the continuance to our own day of the old belief that a fanatical Mussulman is a formidable soldier.

The only Mussulman people who in recent times have done anything in war to sustain this belief are the Afghans, and yet they have never shown real tenacity on a set field. They have shown, however, wonderful tenacity in continuing hostilities. They have the unconquerable hate, and the courage never to submit or yield, which are supposed to be characteristics of all Mohammedan zealots, but they do not show it under arms. They fly nearly as readily as the Egyptians, but they do not throw away their arms, and they are always ready to try again, and they never kiss a conqueror's hand. They make their submission with dignity.

The suddenness and completeness of the Egyptian collapse will probably have some effect on European diplomacy in the East, by diminishing the impression of the intracta-

bility and ferocity of Mohammedan populations, which has really had considerable influence thus far in upholding the Turkish Empire. Down to the Russo-Turkish war of 1877 it was quite common for the Turkish Ministers to repress the troublesome importunity of foreign Ministers by hinting at an outbreak of fanaticism which would put Christian lives and property in danger, and which the Government would be unable to control. One argument, too, and a very effective one, used against the introduction of reforms into Asia Minor by extraneous pressure, has been that the population being mainly Mussulman, it would be difficult for any power but the Porte to control them, and that, deplorable as their lot was under Turkish rule, they must be left to their fate as long as their master did not care to improve it. What has occurred in Egypt is therefore not unlikely to make the ambassadors at Constantinople less gingerly in using pressure, and less troubled by the accounts the pashas will give of the effect on the Turkish people of concessions to infidels.

ARABI AND HIS ARMY.

KNOXVILLE, TENN., Sept. 16, 1882.

It was my fortune—good or ill, it is hard to say—to spend something over two years in Egypt, in the service of the late Khedive, Ismail Pasha, as an officer of Engineers in his Army. I lived in Cairo with my family, was daily in intimate association with the native population, and had charge, as Chief of the Third Section, of the General Staff of the Topographical Bureau. I trust that the opportunities offered for observation have made me somewhat familiar with the country and its people.

Since the days of Mehemet Ali, and his great warrior son, Ibrahim Pasha, Egypt has entirely lost her military prestige; she has had no recent victories of any importance. It is true that during the reign of the Khedive Ismail Pasha the boundaries of Egyptian dominion were extended, apparently by military conquest, over a part of Nubia, Darfur, Kordofan, and up the Nile almost to the Equatorial Lakes. But these conquests were really not won by fighting successful battles; they were the results of creating dissensions among the native tribes, of purchase and bribery, of superior diplomacy and treachery, of following up the march of trade by detachments of troops, and converting trading stations into forts and military posts. In 1876 the Egyptian troops under Rauf Pasha made a successful attack upon Harrar, a walled town of the Sumalis. With this single exception, all of their recent military efforts have been most disastrous failures. I need only mention the series of terrible catastrophes attending the abortive attempts at conquest in Abyssinia during the years 1875 and 1876. The writer was one of the unfortunates who participated in those inglorious undertakings, and knows whereof he speaks. The first expedition into Abyssinia was under Colonel Arendrup, a Danish officer in the service of the Khedive. He commanded a column of troops of all arms, numbering about 3,500 men. They were apparently excellent troops, were well organized, well drilled, well armed, and well equipped in every way; and yet on the very first encounter with the Abyssinians the entire force engaged was literally wiped out of existence. Only a few desperately wounded, maimed, and mutilated men, who were left as dead by their ruthless foes, were the survivors of that bloody fight. These wretched sufferers,

with wonderful vitality, crawled off the field of carnage, hid themselves by day in the caves and jungles, fed on wild fruits and berries, dragged their festering limbs along at night, and reached Massowah, some of them weeks after the battle, and told the horrible tale.

To wipe out this disgrace and avenge this defeat, a large army, which ultimately numbered fully 20,000 men, equally as well appointed in all respects as the other force, was sent into Abyssinia. They reached the Abyssinian plateau without resistance, and about 12,000 of them at one time were engaged with the hordes of King John. Of all that met the King in the open field, but very few returned to the two forts which formed the flanks of their position. I have no intention of giving a description of this battle of Gura, as it is called, but simply of showing the fighting capacity of the Egyptian troops. The position occupied by the Egyptian Army was an excellent one: they were on an open, nearly level plain, themselves posted on the rising ground; they were splendidly equipped with Remington breech-loading rifles; their artillery was composed of French mountain-howitzers, English steel guns, and German Krupps, besides a fine rocket battery; their cavalry was magnificently mounted and perfectly armed; they were commanded by the Commander-in-Chief of the Egyptian Army, and his best officers; they had some dozen or more American and European staff officers to encourage them, exhort them, and set them a good example. King John attacked them squarely in front, with his host of naked, barefooted, bare-headed warriors, who had but few fire-arms, no artillery, no organization—nothing military, in fact, but courage. And yet, in one hour and a half, all of 7,000 troops who were outside of the forts, except a bare handful, were killed or captured by the Abyssinians, who rushed upon them with sword and spear and shield, and slaughtered them like sheep in the shambles. The loss of the Abyssinians was about 150 men!

This bare statement of facts makes comment unnecessary. How it all happened it is difficult to tell. Colonel Dye, who was in the battle, wrote a book to explain it, but did not succeed, I think, even to his own satisfaction. Why it so happened is easier to answer, and the answer is this: the Egyptians will not, cannot fight. A disaster equally complete, but on a smaller scale, occurred to a column of Egyptian troops under Munzinger Pasha, nearly contemporaneously with the Arendrup tragedy. This column was marching through the Galla country to coöperate with Arendrup, and, when several days' journey from Tajurrah, was attacked at night by the natives, and absolutely annihilated. The writer saw one of the victims of this catastrophe, who escaped because his wounds were thought to be certainly fatal. He was an officer of Engineers, and will be mentioned again.

The events thus briefly epitomized plainly demonstrate the lack of fighting qualities of the Egyptians. Now, the question naturally arises, Why are they thus utterly worthless as soldiers? That question it is the main object of this article to answer. There are two classes of soldiers in the ranks of the Egyptian Army. The smaller class consists of Nubians, Darfurians, Sudanese, and Berbers from up the Nile. Many, in fact it is said that most of them, are slaves, either taken or bought from the regular slave-hunters and traders of the interior, and liberated by the late Khedive Ismail, by being placed in the Army. However recruited, they constituted the only fighting part of the Army in the Abyssinian campaign, and they were vastly inferior to the colored troops of the Union Army during the late Civil War. They have some soldierly quali-

ties: they are strong, hardy, able-bodied men, can stand heat and hard work and long marches well; they are docile, obedient, and seemed to learn the routine duties of military life readily, and perhaps under good officers might make fairly good soldiers. Some of these negro troops went with Prince Hassan to Turkey, and participated in the Russo-Turkish war; but there was no mention made of any brilliant achievements accomplished by them, and it was said they suffered terribly from the coldness of the climate of the mountain regions of Turkey, and were therefore of little service.

The larger part of the Egyptian Army is made up of recruits taken by conscription from the villages and fields of the lower delta. These fellahen are the most abject of slaves, and have been so for hundreds of years. They are not slaves of a single owner who would be responsible for their welfare, and would profit by their well-being, as was the case with the former slaves of the South. They are the slaves of the soil upon which they live, and of every man who occupies a higher position in life than they, from their own sheik-el-beled to the Khedive. Every effendi, bey, and pasha with whom they come in contact in any way whatever looks upon them as different beings from himself, calls them habitually "ebn-el-kelb," sons of dogs, and kicks, cuffs, and beats them *ad libitum*. In consequence of this bad treatment, and by heredity, they are low, mean, cowardly, and cringing beyond any people on the face of the earth. And the manner in which they are drafted into the Army, and the way they are subsequently treated by their officers, does not in the least improve them. They are dragged from their fields while at work, or snatched from their mud huts, chained together in gangs, and carried to the citadel, and there kept in close imprisonment until they are drilled and uniformed. They are not allowed to settle their own affairs, to make any provision for their families, or even to bid their wives and children farewell, when the time for their conscription comes. When the recruiting sergeants lay hands upon them, it is as if a sudden and terrible death had claimed them; and they are mourned and wept over by friends and relatives as if they were dead.

Once become soldiers, and branded as it were by the uniform, escape from the ranks, until term of service expires, is impossible. Desertion is generally punished by death, even in time of peace. They are treated by their officers no better than they were by their taskmasters in the fields. The courbash is the instrument of punishment for every trivial offence, in spite of the fact that flogging is prohibited by law. Not only is the common soldier whipped by his company officers, from sergeant to captain, but even the subaltern officers are subjected to the same indignity by their superiors. The writer once saw a lieutenant held down by two men of his own company, while his colonel beat him unmercifully with a walking-cane. When the beating was finished by the bey's becoming exhausted, the lieutenant arose, took off his sword and handed it to his superior, and said: "You have disgraced me in the presence of my own men; I am no longer worthy to be an officer—put me in the ranks." For this—the only manly act I ever witnessed among these people—the lieutenant was charged with insubordination and mutinous conduct, was tried by court-martial, was sentenced to be shot, and I saw the sentence put into execution.

This was during the Abyssinian campaign; and on another occasion I witnessed the novel sight of a colonel giving his own major a good thrashing with a walking-cane, and the major took it like a lamb, without a murmur or even

a grunt of disapprobation. The lieutenant of Engineers mentioned above as having escaped from the Munzinger massacre, had receipted to the Government for some engineer stores and a small sum of money for engineering purposes. Although he came back to Cairo desperately wounded, and brought back a few of his engineer troops, yet he was tried for the loss of the property and money, and his pay was stopped until the loss was made good. This is not hearsay. This lieutenant was in my own corps of Topographical Engineers. I was his chief, and had to approve his pay-account, and I know all the circumstances just detailed to be facts.

No wonder, then, that such a people—so treated when in civil life that every spark of manhood is crushed out of them, and so abused as soldiers that they have not even the courage of a crushed worm, which strives to sting the heel of its destroyer—no wonder such a people will not fight. And the inglorious termination of Arabi Pasha's wretched attempt at revolution is but the legitimate result of his and his deluded followers' antecedents. No one who knew him and his people had any doubt how the affair would end from its very incipency. I made Arabi Bey's acquaintance in Abyssinia. He was then a lieutenant-colonel. After the Egyptian Army was defeated by King John, Arabi Bey was made an envoy, and sent to the King with presents and bribes, and propositions for peace. He was so far successful in his mission that King John gave the Egyptian Army an opportunity to retreat from his country without molestation. For this brilliant achievement Arabi Bey was promoted to the rank of colonel, made a bey of the first class, and decorated with the order of the Medjidieh. This cumulation of honors turned his head. He was probably, at that time, the only native Arab who held so high a rank—the beys and pashas being universally Turks or Circassians. He imagined himself a great man, and thought he was chosen of fate as the deliverer of his people.

A few words as to the conduct of the campaign on both sides. Arabi Pasha has done better than I ever thought he would. He held his troops together quite well, and manœuvred them well, for a man whose natural ability is not great, whose education is meagre, and whose military experience has been small. It is my opinion that Arabi Pasha has received instructions from a source little suspected by most people. That he should have made his first serious stand at Tel-el-Kebir, with his back as it were resting on Zagazig, shows that some one wiser than himself put the idea into his head that that position was the key to the Nile delta. He must have learned that from General Stone—not since the General has cast his fortunes with the Khedive, of course, but before that time, and before Arabi Pasha put himself in the attitude of open rebellion. It was a favorite idea of General Stone's that Tel-el-Kebir and Zagazig would one day be of great moment in Egyptian affairs. I have frequently heard him speak of their strategic importance; and when I tendered my resignation in 1875, the General told me he regretted my leaving before I had helped him fortify *these two places*.

Sir Garnet Wolseley has conducted the attack upon the Egyptians in a manner altogether admirable. In view of all the difficulties he has had to encounter, his progress has been remarkably rapid. His taking Ismailia for his base of operations put him on the shortest line of march to Cairo. His gradually forcing the enemy back until he could get all of his forces together at their strongest point may have looked to some unwise and unmilitary, but it was exactly the right thing to do with the foe he had. In this way he was enabled to deal one deadly blow

and end the war at once. This he knew he would be able to do. Finally, the manner of engaging the Egyptians showed his perfect knowledge of their calibre, and his consummate skill. He went at them with a rush, as the Abyssinians did, and that was the end of the whole matter.

S. H. L.

THE RELIGIOUS CONDITION OF ENGLAND—THE SALVATION ARMY.

LONDON, September 7, 1882.

THE doings of a body which calls itself the Salvation Army have, during the last few months, excited an amount of attention from the educated classes in England which is chiefly remarkable as showing how little those educated classes seem to have previously known, or cared about, the religious phenomena which manifest themselves among the humbler part of the population. I will not attempt to write the history of the movement, which for the matter of that has lately been set forth in one of our best magazines, the *Contemporary Review*, by its founder and dictator, General Booth; but the occasion is a suitable one for saying something about the state of religious belief and practice among the masses in England, and considering how far such organizations as this are calculated to amend it.

Amendment it certainly needs. Whether the poorest class, the day laborers in town and country, were in the habit of attending church and shaping their conduct with some reference to what they heard there, even in Roman Catholic times, may be doubted; it is at any rate not so certain as Roman Catholic writers are apt to assume in talking of "ages of faith." But since the Reformation there seems to have been always a section of the poor who lay outside religious agencies, and with the growth of great towns this section has naturally grown vastly larger. At present, of the artisan and laboring class in the towns—the class which lives by weekly or daily wages for manual labor—certainly less than a half, and perhaps only a fourth, can be said to belong to any church or denomination: that is to say, to be in the habit of regularly attending any place of worship. The more intelligent and active-minded artisans are chiefly Dissenters, and for the most part Methodists—we have, like you, several different Methodist bodies—or Baptists. The Irish are, of course, Roman Catholics, and a certain number—small but capable of being increased whenever an energetic clergyman appears on the scene—still adhere to the Established Church. In the purely agricultural parts of England the proportion of churchgoers is larger, and the strength of the Anglican establishment greater; in Scotland, too, religion has, even in the towns, a stronger hold on the mass of the people than in the manufacturing or mining districts of England. To return, however, to these last-mentioned districts, their condition is a very disheartening one. To what extent atheism, or secularism, as it is now usually called, prevails among them, cannot easily be determined, though the small support which Mr. Bradlaugh and other lecturers of his type receive seems to show that the secularist organizations do not count many members. But there is a vast section of the working class which, whether or not it has any theological or anti-theological opinions, lives practically uninfluenced by religion, and comes in contact with the ministers of religion only on the occasion of baptisms, weddings, and funerals. Add to this that there is also among our poorer classes, as well in country as in town, a vast deal of wretchedness, chiefly caused by intemperance, and a good deal of violent crime directly arising from intoxication.